

I have sent her away? or who of my creditors is it to whom I have sold you? behold, for your iniquities were ye sold, and for your transgressions was your mother sent away.

2 Why did I come and no man was there, did I call, with none to answer? hath my hand become too short for redeeming? or is there no power in me to deliver? behold, through my threatening I can dry up the sea, I can change the rivers into a wilderness: their fish stink for want of water, and die for thirst.

3 I can clothe the heavens with blackness, and I can make sackcloth their garment.

4 ¶ The Lord Eternal hath given me a tongue for teaching,^a that I should know how to strengthen the weary with the word: he wakeneth morning by morning, he wakeneth my ear to listen like those who are well taught.

5 The Lord Eternal hath opened me my ear, and I resisted not: I turned not backward.

6 My back I gave up to the smiters, and my cheeks to those that plucked off the hair: my face I hid not from abuse and spitting.

7 But the Lord Eternal ever helpeth me; therefore was I not confounded; therefore have I rendered my face like a flint, and I knew that I should not be made ashamed.

8 He that justifieth me is near; who will contend with me? let us stand forward together: who hath a dispute^b with me? let him come near to me.

9 Behold, the Lord Eternal will help me; who is the man that will condemn me? lo, they all shall wear out as a garment: the moth shall eat them up.

10 ¶ Who is among you that feareth the LORD, that harkeneth to the voice of his servant? though he have walked in darkness, and had no light: let him trust in the name of the LORD, and lean for support upon his God.

11 Behold, all ye that kindle fire, that urge^c on the brands: walk by the blaze of your fire, and by the brands ye have kindled; from my hand hath this been bestowd on you; in pain shall ye lie down.

^a Rashi; but Redak, "a tongue of the practised," i. e. those who have been well trained. Philippon, "disciples;" and so at the end, "to understand like disciples."

^b Lit. "the master of my cause."

^c Lit. "gird," i. e. "arm," or "urge," in this connection.

^d Philippon, "how I called him, the one."

CHAPTER LI.

1 ¶ Hearken to me, ye that pursue righteousness, that seek the LORD: look unto the rock whence ye were hewn, and to the hole of the pit whence ye were dug up.

2 Look unto Abraham your father, and unto Sarah that bore you; for^d he was one when I called him, and I blessed him, and I increased him.

3 Yea, the LORD hath^e comforted Zion; he hath comforted all her ruins; and he hath made her wilderness like Eden, and her desert like the garden of the LORD: gladness and joy shall be found therein, thanksgiving, and the voice of song.

4 ¶ Listen unto me, my people; and O my nation, give ear unto me; for a law shall proceed from me, and my justice will I establish as a light of the people.

5 My righteousness is near; my salvation goeth forth, and my arms shall judge the people: on me the isles shall wait, and for my arm shall they hope.

6 Lift up your eyes to the heavens, and look upon the earth beneath; for the heavens shall vanish away like smoke, and the earth shall wear out like a garment, and they that dwell thereon shall die in like manner; but my salvation shall exist for ever, and my righteousness shall not be delayed.^f

7 ¶ Hearken unto me, ye that know righteousness, O people in whose heart my law is: ye must not fear the reproach of men, and of their revilings shall ye not be in dread.

8 For like a garment shall the moth eat them up, and like wool shall the worm eat them; but my righteousness shall exist for ever, and my salvation from generation to generation.

9 ¶ Awake, awake, put on strength, O arm of the LORD: awake, as in the ancient days, in the generations of olden times. Art thou not it that struck down Rahab,^g that pierced the crocodile?

10 Art thou not it that dried up the sea, the waters of the great deep; that rendered

^e The prophetic past, representing the future as already come.

^f Jonathan. Redak, "broken."

^g Allegorical term for "Egypt." The crocodile, as rendered by Philippon, or "dragon," by others, denotes Pharaoh, who is frequently so called by the prophets. The word תנין is difficult to translate with an equivalent in

the depths of the sea a road for the redeemed to pass through?

11 And (so) shall the ransomed of the LORD return, and come to Zion with song, with everlasting joy upon their head; gladness and joy shall they obtain, while sorrow and sighing shall have fled away.

12 ¶ I, I am he that comforteth you: who art thou, that thou shouldst be afraid of a mortal that must die, and of a son of man who will wither as the grass?

13 And thou forgettest the LORD, thy Maker, who hath spread out the heavens, and laid the foundations of the earth; and thou darest continually, all the day, because of the fury of the oppressor, whenever he aimeth to destroy: and where is (now) the fury of the oppressor?

14 The exile will be speedily set free; and he shall not die in the dungeon, and his bread shall not fail.

15 For I am the LORD thy God, who stirreth^a up the sea that its waves roar: the LORD of hosts is his name.

16 And I have placed my words in thy mouth, and with the shadow of my hand have I covered thee: to plant^b the heavens, and to lay the foundations of the earth, and to say to Zion, Thou art my people.

17 ¶ Rouse up, rouse up, arise, O Jerusalem, thou who hast drunk from the hand of the LORD the cup of his fury: the deep^c cup of confusion hast thou drunk, hast thou drained.

18 There is none to lead her, from all the children whom she hath born; and there is none that taketh her by the hand, from all the children whom she hath brought up.

19 Two things are these which have befallen thee: who will have compassion for thee? desolation and destruction, and famine and the sword—with whom shall I comfort thee?

20 Thy children have fainted, they lie at the entrance of all streets, as a wild bull caught in a net, (they are those) who are full

of the fury of the LORD, the threatening of thy God.

21 Therefore hear now this, O thou afflicted, and drunken, but not with wine.

22 ¶ Thus hath said thy Lord, the ETERNAL, and thy God, who will ever plead for his people, Behold, I have taken out of thy hand the cup of confusion, the deep cup of my fury: thou shalt never more drink it again.

23 And I will place it in the hand of those who have tortured thee, that have said to thy soul, Bend thee down, that we may pass over; and thou madest like the earth thy back, and like the street for those that passed over.

CHAPTER LII.

1 ¶ Awake, awake, put on thy strength,^a O Zion; put on thy beautiful garments, O Jerusalem, thou holy city; for no more shall enter into thee henceforth the uncircumcised and the unclean.

2 Shake thyself free from the dust, arise,^b sit down, O Jerusalem: loosen thyself from the bands of thy neck, O captive, daughter of Zion.

3 ¶ For thus hath said the LORD, For naught were you sold, and without silver shall ye be redeemed.

4 ¶ For thus hath said the Lord Eternal, Into Egypt went my people down aforetimes, to sojourn there, and Asshur hath oppressed it without cause.

5 And now what have I here, saith the LORD, since my people hath been taken away for naught? its rulers vaunt aloud, saith the LORD, and continually, all the day, is my name blasphemed.

6 Therefore shall my people know my name, therefore—on that day, that I am he that speaketh it: here am I.

7 ¶ How beautiful are upon the mountains the feet of the messenger of good tidings, that publisheth peace, that announceth tidings of

other languages. In Gen. i. 21, it evidently means simply "the large marine animals;" in Exod. vii. 10, it is equally clear that it denotes "serpent;" the general term "monster," something large, frightful, and unusual, would best express it; and the context must then determine what sort of a creature is likely the subject of the discourse.

^a Jonathan, "who assuageth the sea when its waves roar." The difficulty is in the word יָרַךְ, to which opposite meanings are attached.

^b The commentators say that this refers to the preservation of Israel, as important as the creation, and the gathering of the captives.

^c Jonathan. But Rashi, "the dregs of the cup," כִּבְרֵית is given by Sachs with "arched cup."

^d Sachs, "(decoration of) victory."

^e Sachs, "sit erect;" but the verse simply says that the captives who formerly lay bound in the dust shall spring up from the earth and sit on a seat of ease, like other freemen.

happiness, that publisheth salvation, that saith unto Zion, Thy God reigneth.

8 The voice of thy watchmen,—they raise their voice, together shall they shout; for eye to eye shall they see, when the LORD returneth unto Zion.

9 Break forth (in song), shout together, ye ruins of Jerusalem; for the LORD hath comforted his people, he hath redeemed Jerusalem.

10 The LORD hath made bare his holy arm before the eyes of all the nations; and all the ends of the earth shall see the salvation of our God.

11 ¶ Depart ye, depart ye, go out from there, touch no unclean thing; go ye out from the midst of it; cleanse yourselves, ye bearers of the vessels of the LORD.

12 For not in haste shall ye go out, and not in flight shall ye go; for before you goeth the LORD, and your rereward is the God of Israel.

13 ¶ Behold, my servant^a shall be prosperous, he shall be exalted and extolled, and be placed very high.

^a Rashi, explains "my servant." "Behold, at the end of days will my servant Jacob, the righteous among him, be prosperous." Dr. Philippon heads this section, "the sufferings of Israel conduce to the happiness of the nations;" and after reviewing the preceding prophecies, he says, "But if the prophet contrasts in chap. xlix. 7, in general terms, the despised state of Israel with their future greatness, he takes a deeper view of the subject in the speech now before us, (to the end of liii.), as he declares the present degradation of Israel to be NECESSARY for the accomplishment of their mission; because the exaltation of this depressed, the glorious uprising of this despised people will prove so clearly, so surprisingly to the other nations the saving power of the sole God, whom the Israelites adore, that they will become converted to this only ONE. The prophet goes, therefore, a step farther, in declaring the sufferings of Israel, in general terms, as borne by Israel merely as the means of happiness for the nations, in order to bring these out of their sinful idolatry to the pure acknowledgment of God. They are become the martyrs of the acknowledgment of the ONE, and by their exaltation the nations will be directed with the strength of conviction to the sole and only God. This view of the prophet is truly sublime; he stands here on the summit of the whole history of the world, since he thus recognises and pursues the universal tendency of all the history of the families of man. The doubts, therefore, which Jewish commentators (Redak and Abaranel) have raised here, that this procedure would be opposed to the justice of God, which must allow every one to bear the punishment of what he himself has committed, can only be applied to individuals, while the prophet had in view the whole development of mankind. The prophet now expresses this idea in the following manner:—At first he speaks of the future greatness of Israel (lii. 13), which shall be as great

14 Just as many were astonished at thee, so greatly was his countenance marred more than any (other) man's, and his form more than (that of) the sons of men,—

15 Thus will he cause many nations to jump^b up in (astonishment); at him will kings shut their mouth; for what had not been told unto them shall they see, and what they had never heard shall they understand.

CHAPTER LIII.

1 Who would have believed our^c report? and the arm of the LORD—over whom hath it been revealed?

2 Yea, he grew up like a small shoot before him, and as a root out of a dry land: he had no form nor comeliness, so that we should look at him; and no countenance, so that we should desire him.

3 He^d was despised and shunned by men; a man of pains, and acquainted with disease; and as one^e who hid his face from us was he despised, and we esteemed him not.

as the Israelites are at present depressed (14). At this the nations and kings will be astonished to the utmost (15), and they will call to mind the entire state of degradation under which the Israelites have suffered, when seeing that it is precisely this people which have been redeemed and raised so high by the sole God (liii. 1-3). But they will thence acknowledge that Israel had to bear this hard fate solely for their (the nations') redemption out of their sinful state (4-6), so that Israel, through the patience which they exhibit notwithstanding all their sufferings, since they never departed from the only God, shall be placed on a yet higher eminence (7-9). Therefore will Israel be the more greatly exalted and rendered happy by God, and the will of the Most High will be accomplished through them (10-12).^f This view is generally shared by the best commentators, and is perfectly reconcilable to the whole context and the separate expressions employed.

^b Jonathan, "scatter." Rashi follows the same view. Redak, "he will cause to speak." Heinemann, "will set in motion." Sachs, "astonish." We have followed Philippon, who explains it to mean the sudden effect of unexpected news. This is farther exemplified by the first verse of the next chapter.

^c Rashi, "So will the nations say one to the other, Had we heard from the mouth of others what we see ourselves, it would have been incredible; and on whom was such a power and majesty of the LORD revealed till now?" But Philippon, "it appears incredible that God should do so much for so small a people."

^d Rashi, "This is the method of the prophet, to speak of all Israel as one man, as above, 'Fear not, my servant Jacob,' (xlv. 2, and *ibid.* 21)."

^e Rashi, "On account of their great shame and lowness they were as those who hide their faces from us with the